DAY 11

You Do Not Have to Carry Everything



"By helping one another carry burdens, we live the love Christ taught."

GALATIANS 6:2

Perhaps you are the person everyone turns to. You organize, resolve problems, remember details, and notice what is missing before anyone asks. Over time, that role can become an identity: you feel useful while supporting others. But when you need help, you do not know how to ask. Taking the place of someone receiving care seems wrong.

Paul's instruction to the Galatians describes a community where burdens are shared. Christ's love is expressed in willingness to help. That includes offering companionship and allowing someone to approach our needs. If everyone had to appear strong continually, no one would find room to offer that care.

You lose no dignity by admitting a situation has exceeded your strength. Loss, illness, financial hardship, and prolonged responsibilities bring burdens that should not be faced in isolation. Seeking support does not make them small, but can keep loneliness from adding pain to what is already difficult.

Sometimes the obstacle is believing no one will help as well as you. That may be true of a detail, but not the whole task. Accepting support often means releasing control over exactly how everything is done. A simple meal, a ride, or an attentive listener can ease the day without reproducing your way of caring.

There is also fear of being a bother. You imagine others' reactions before giving them a chance to respond. Not everyone will be available, and choosing whom to trust with intimate matters requires discernment. But refusal or limitation does not make your need illegitimate. You may need another relationship or more appropriate help.

Likewise, helping someone does not require taking over their entire life. Healthy care respects responsibilities and boundaries. You can accompany without deciding everything, support without accepting abuse, and contribute without promising what you cannot fulfill. Sharing burdens is a loving relationship, not permission to exploit another's availability.

Look kindly at the role you usually occupy. Have you hidden a need because everyone expects you to be fine? An honest conversation may allow someone to see beyond your competence. Receiving care also teaches us in faith. You discover you can be loved when you are solving nothing and that your presence matters more than the services you provide.



TO KEEP IN YOUR HEART

You can receive the care you usually offer others.

TODAY'S PRAYER



Lord, I struggle to recognize my needs and allow anyone to help. Teach me to receive care gratefully without believing it diminishes my worth. Give me discernment to seek trustworthy people and honesty to explain what I need. Help me offer support with clear boundaries, respecting my capacity and the other's responsibility. Keep strength from becoming a compulsory appearance. Bring me into relationships where we can share burdens and live Your love truthfully. Amen.